How to Prepare Your Final Capstone Presentation?

CIS 485: Directed Research in Computer and Information Sciences

Spring 2026

Disclaim

- Capstone Final Presentation is scheduled on **April. 29, 2026 at 5:10pm**.
- It is in-person in SN 229.
- We will use a similar format as final presentations
  - No spelling and grammar errors!!!
  - Slides will be prepared following a similar format as well.

Basic Information for Final Presentation and Slides

- Each team will have about 10-12 minutes
  - 10 minute presentation + 2 minutes Q&A
  - Practice to fit around 10 minutes.
- Make sure your presentation is NOT a repeat of your proposal presentation.
  - Don't repeat any annotations of articles you have already covered in the proposal presentation.
  - However, it is ok to talk about new resources if you find any.
- Prepare your slides carefully. Be sure you know what you put on the slides.

More Do and Don't

- Do use a template
  - Choose one from Design menu
- Do pick simple, basic PowerPoint template
  - Choose one from Academic category
- Don't choose templates that are too fancy
  - Again, it is an academic presentation for college capstone
- Don't overuse the colors and fonts

Your Very First Slide

- Be sure to have a title and date
  - Think about an official title for your capstone project!
- Also include information about yourself
- See next slide for a sample…

Comparative Performance Analysis between Docker Swarm and Kubernetes – Midterm Report

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Slide of Presentation Outline

- Do include a Presentation Outline slide such as
  - Introduction/Background
  - Motivation
  - Research Methods
  - …
  - Results
  - Demo
  - **Summary**

- During the presentation, bring this slide once in a while. Dim the items that are already covered.
  - In this way, your audience wouldn't lose track of your talk.

Table of Contents – Sample

- Introduction/Background
- Motivation
- Research Methods
- …
- **Results**
- **Demo**
- Intended Features (if we get more time)
- Summary

Table of Contents – show it again after one or two items are done

- Introduction/Background
- Motivation
- Research Methods
- ….
- Results
- Demo
- Intended Features (if we get more time)
- Summary

Organize Your Slides

- The items in your Presentation Outline must be logically related.
- Divide your presentation into logically-related sections
- You want to show your audience that your capstone project
  - Is an integrated research project;
  - Is NOT some random subjects being put together;
  - Is NOT a tutorial!

For each slide

- Normally about 90 seconds per slide, but it varies from people to people.
  - Do practice!!!
- Don't put too much text on slides.
  - Do NOT put sentences; put bullet lists instead!
- Keep each slide at most 6 lines of text

- Write summary points in a bullet list; do NOT just type exactly what you are saying!
- Focus on a few main points; don't overwhelm your audience

More on each slide…

- Have main bullet points start with a similar part of speech.
- Write just a few lines of text for each point.
  - Keep it concise.
- Keep text to a minimum.
  - More information should go to a **Notes** card

Images

- It is always a good idea to put some pictures
- Make your own pictures as you can, or
- Use copyright-free images
  - https://www.flickr.com/creativecommons/
- Add reference information for images you used except your own images
- Make sure the images are relevant to your research subject
  - Don't use cute clip art unless you know what you are doing
    - Hi, I just borrowed pictures from my little sister who is in 2nd grade. Don't!

Videos

- Make the videos short
- Limit to 1 minute unless necessary (since we have only 10 minutes)
  - For conference that each speaker gets 30 minutes, you may put longer video clips
- Don’t put too many videos.
  - It is your presentation

Practice, practice, practice!

- Present your materials to your family or friends as many times as you can.
- Time your presentation so it falls within the allocated time.
- **Practice and write down some notes.**
  - We all may get nervous and forget what to say.

- Get all team members in practice on Zoom or Google Handout!
  - Don’t let any team member sitting there clueless during presentation!!!

Table of Contents – show it again after some items are done to keep audience on track

- Introduction/Background
- Motivation
- Research Methods
- …
- Initial Results and Current Status
- ➢ Demo

At this time, you stop your slides and start your demo..

- Intended Features (if we get more time)
- Summary

About Summary

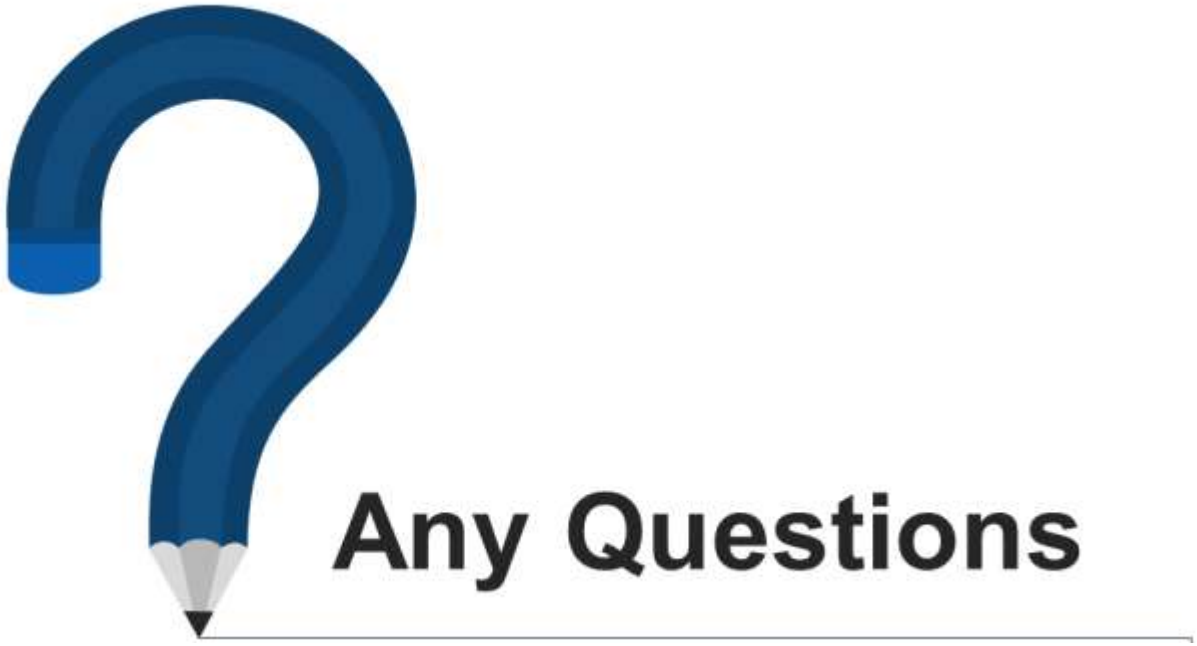
- Do include a Summary slide to sum up your research!
- It aims to provide a brief, condensed summary of your capstone project and its current status
- Use one “summary" slide (no more than 2).
- Avoid lengthy, cumbersome sentences
  - List the main ideas using bullet points.

Add a Q&A slide to the end

- It is a good idea to add a Questions and Answers slide to the very end.
- In this way, we won’t forget to ask questions in the end.

In Summary

- Relax, be comfortable and confident.
  - You have been working on this subject for a semester, so you shouldn’t afraid of any questions
- Make eye contact as you can.
- Pace your presentation
  - When you bring back **Table of Contents** slides, drink some water and ask questions.


Any Questions